Editor's Note

THIS is the most important and comprehensive single volume of Netaji's works yet published.

The book is in two parts. The first is Netaji's narrative of the Indian struggle from 1920 to 1942. The second consists of a collection of writings, speeches and other documentary material covering the decade that ended with the Quit India Movement. As to Netaji's original narrative of the twenty-two years, — from the birth of Non-co-operation to the August Revolution — any commentary is superfluous. The material provided in the second part, many of them so far unpublished, are complementary to the foregoing narrative. They will undoubtedly contribute to a fuller understanding of the author, his ideology and technique of struggle.

Netaji wrote the first part of the narrative (1920-1934) as an exile in Europe and the book was first published in London on the 17th January 1935. It was particularly well reviewed in the British press and warmly welcomed in European literary and political circles. The British Government in India, however, lost no time in prohibiting its entry into India on the plea that the book tended generally to encourage methods of terrorism and direct action. The latter part of the narrative (1935-1942) was also written in Europe — eight years later — during World War II. The manuscript was obtained from Vienna after the war. A reprint of the London publication was issued in India in 1948 and the history of the period 1935-1942 published separately in 1952. Both of these have unfortunately been out of print for years.

It is known that a German translation of the entire narrative had been in preparation during Netaji's last sojourn in Europe in 1941-43 but it never saw the light of day. An Italian edition was, however, published in 1942 under the auspices of the Italian Institute of Middle and Far Eastern Affairs.

In presenting the narrative in its entirety, minor changes in title and arrangement have been made in the interest of the reader. The appendix in the original London edition appears in this book as "Epilogue 1934" and it precedes instead of following, the